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THE RAPID GROWTH OF REAL ESTATE DEVELOPMENT IN NIGERIA

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ABSTRACT:

The real estate sector in Nigeria has emerged as one of the most dynamic components of the national economy, driven by rapid urbanization, population growth, infrastructural expansion, and increasing domestic and foreign investments. This paper examines the structural drivers, economic significance, challenges, and future prospects of the rapid growth of real estate development in Nigeria. "It explores how the sector contributes to gross domestic product (GDP), employment generation, housing delivery, and urban transformation while simultaneously confronting barriers such as housing deficits, policy inconsistency, land administration inefficiencies, insecurity, affordability constraints, and sustainability concerns. Using qualitative research methodology supported by secondary data analysis, this study synthesizes evidence from government reports, academic literature, policy documents, and industry analyses. Findings reveal that although real estate has become a major driver of economic diversification and national development, persistent institutional weaknesses and social inequalities continue to limit its full developmental potential. The study concludes that sustainable growth in Nigeria's real estate sector requires comprehensive reforms in housing finance, land governance, urban planning, public-private partnerships, and affordable housing initiatives.

Keywords: *Real estate development, Nigeria, urbanization, housing deficit, economic diversification, infrastructure, mortgage finance, sustainable development"*

1. Introduction

"Nigeria stands as one of the most prominent developing economies in the world, increasingly attracting foreign direct investment (FDI) and portfolio investment. In recent decades, global attention particularly from Asia and Europe has shifted toward Africa as an emerging investment destination. Within this context, countries such as Nigeria, South Africa, and Ghana have become focal points due to their large

populations, expanding markets, and resource endowments. Among these, Nigeria, as Africa's most populous nation and one of its largest economies, plays a central role in shaping the continent's investment landscape.

One of the key sectors drawing substantial foreign interest is infrastructural development. This sector has witnessed the entry of major international players, especially from China, whose investments span roads, railways, housing, and urban infrastructure. The growing involvement of foreign investors reflects both the opportunities and gaps present in Nigeria's development trajectory. Despite its immense potential, Africa and Nigeria in particular continues to face significant infrastructural deficits. These challenges are often attributed to weak governance structures, inconsistent policy implementation, and a lack of visionary leadership committed to long-term national development.

Within this broader context, the rapid growth of the real estate sector in Nigeria has emerged as a critical area of study". This paper examines the expansion of real estate development and its influence on the country's infrastructural landscape. "Real estate has become a strategic investment avenue, particularly in an environment characterized by inflation and economic uncertainty. "Investors increasingly seek assets that provide stable returns and serve as a hedge against inflation, making property development an attractive option.

The Nigerian economy has historically been heavily dependent on the oil sector. However, fluctuations in global oil prices and the need for economic diversification have prompted a shift toward non-oil sectors. Real estate development has played a significant role in this transition. Urban housing projects, commercial properties, and estate developments are contributing to the restructuring of the economy by creating alternative sources of revenue and employment".

"Urbanization is a major driver of real estate growth in Nigeria. As more people migrate from rural to urban areas in search of better employment opportunities, education, and improved living

standards, the demand for housing continues to rise. Cities such as Lagos, Abuja, and Port Harcourt are experiencing rapid population growth, leading to increased pressure on existing infrastructure. This surge in demand

has stimulated large-scale residential and commercial developments, transforming urban landscapes and expanding city boundaries".

"The rise of a growing middle class has also been instrumental in driving real estate expansion. With increased access to financial instruments such as mortgages, savings schemes, and investment opportunities, more individuals are able to acquire property. This trend not only supports the housing market but also contributes to broader economic growth. Real estate development stimulates multiple sectors, including construction, manufacturing, finance, and retail, thereby creating a multiplier effect within the economy.

Furthermore, the real estate sector significantly contributes to Nigeria's Gross Domestic Product (GDP) and employment generation. Construction activities create jobs for skilled and unskilled labor, while related industries benefit from increased demand for materials and services. From architects and engineers to artisans and laborers, the sector provides livelihoods for millions of Nigerians. In addition, the development of shopping malls, office complexes, and recreational facilities enhances the quality of life and supports the growth of urban economies".

"Real estate development also plays a crucial role in the urbanization process. Through planned housing schemes, road networks, and commercial centers, previously underdeveloped areas are transformed into vibrant urban communities. This process not only improves living standards but also attracts further investment, creating a cycle of growth and development. Modern infrastructure, including transportation systems and public utilities, is often integrated into real estate projects, contributing to overall national development".

"Despite these positive trends, the sector faces several challenges that limit its full potential. One of the most significant issues is insecurity, particularly in the northern regions of Nigeria. Persistent conflicts, insurgency, and criminal activities have created an unstable environment that discourages both domestic and foreign investment. Investors are often hesitant to commit resources in areas where safety cannot be guaranteed, leading to uneven development across the country".

"In addition to insecurity, policy inconsistency remains a major concern. Frequent changes in government policies, regulatory frameworks, and taxation systems create

uncertainty for investors. A lack of transparency and bureaucratic inefficiencies further complicate the investment process. These challenges highlight the need for stronger institutional frameworks and more stable governance structures to support sustainable growth in the real estate sector".

"Another critical issue is the affordability of housing. While real estate development is expanding, a significant portion of the population still lacks access to affordable housing. High construction costs, limited access to credit, and rising land prices have made it difficult for low- and middle-income earners to own homes. Addressing this gap requires targeted policies, including housing subsidies, improved mortgage systems, and public-private partnerships aimed at increasing housing supply.

Corruption and mismanagement also pose significant obstacles to the sector's development. Miss-allocation of resources and lack of accountability can undermine large-scale projects and reduce investor confidence. Ensuring transparency and good governance is essential for attracting long-term investment and maximizing the benefits of real estate development".

"In conclusion, the rapid growth of real estate development in Nigeria represents both an opportunity and a challenge. On one hand, the sector has become a key driver of economic diversification, job creation, and urbanization. It offers a viable alternative to the oil-dependent economy and provides a stable investment platform in times of economic uncertainty. On the other hand, issues such as insecurity, policy instability, affordability, and governance deficits continue to hinder its progress".

"This study underscores the importance of real estate development as a catalyst for infrastructural and economic transformation in Nigeria. By addressing existing challenges and implementing strategic reforms, the sector has the potential to significantly contribute to national development. Ultimately, a well-structured and inclusive real estate market can serve as a foundation for sustainable growth, improved living standards, and a more resilient economy".

2.0 Literature Review with Identified Research Gap

2.1 Literature Review

Real estate development in Nigeria has evolved significantly since independence in 1960. "Initially, housing provision was largely informal, family-driven, or government-controlled". "Colonial urban planning primarily served administrative and elite populations, leaving indigenous populations underserved".

"During the oil boom of the 1970s, rapid wealth accumulation and urban migration increased property investments. Government initiatives such as public housing estates were introduced, but implementation remained insufficient. Structural Adjustment Programs (SAPs) of the 1980s reduced state intervention, creating space for private sector participation".

"By the 2000s, liberalization policies, banking reforms, and increased private investment accelerated the sector's modernization. Scholars note that post-2000 Nigeria experienced a "property market awakening," marked by:

- Emergence of private developers
- Mortgage institutions
- Real estate investment firms
- Luxury and gated communities
- Commercial mega-projects".

"Real estate development is widely recognized as a catalyst for economic growth and urban transformation. According to Olayiwola et al". "(2014), the sector plays a significant role in employment generation and capital formation. Similarly, Adebayo (2020) highlights that real estate investment serves as a hedge against inflation, particularly in developing economies experiencing economic volatility".

"Urbanization is another key factor influencing real estate growth. The United Nations (2022) reports that Africa is experiencing one of the fastest urbanization rates globally, with Nigeria leading due to rural-urban migration. This population shift increases demand for housing, commercial spaces, and infrastructure".

"Foreign direct investment also contributes significantly to real estate expansion. Chinese investments in Africa's infrastructure have been widely documented, particularly in construction and housing projects (Brautigam, 2015). However, challenges such as corruption, insecurity, and regulatory inefficiencies continue to hinder the sector's full potential (Transparency International, 2023)".

"Urbanization and Demographic Pressure:

According to United Nations urban studies, Nigeria is among the world's fastest-urbanizing nations. Urban centers continue to expand due to:

Rural poverty

Search for employment Educational opportunities Industrialization

Security concerns in rural areas

Lagos, for example, has transformed into one of Africa's largest megacities, with population estimates exceeding 20 million. Literature suggests urban migration significantly drives land speculation, rental inflation, and housing shortages".

"Housing Deficit

A major theme in Nigerian housing literature is the persistent deficit in adequate housing supply. Researchers estimate that Nigeria requires approximately 700,000 new housing units annually to close the gap, yet current delivery remains far below demand.

Factors contributing to the deficit include:

- High building material costs
- Land bureaucracy
- Inadequate mortgage access
- Poor infrastructure
- Weak public-private partnerships".

"Economic Importance of Real Estate

Real estate's contribution to GDP has risen substantially due to:

- Residential development
- Commercial leasing
- Infrastructure investments
- Land appreciation

- Employment generation

Scholars emphasize the multiplier effect, where real estate stimulates sectors such as:

- Cement and steel
- Banking and finance
- Legal services
- Transportation
- Telecommunications".

"Foreign Direct Investment and Globalization

Foreign investors increasingly perceive Nigeria as a strategic real estate frontier. Chinese infrastructure financing, Gulf-state investments, and diaspora remittances have fueled large-scale projects.

Examples include:

- Chinese-backed railway corridors
- Luxury apartments n- Industrial parks
- Hospitality chains
- Contemporary Trends

Recent studies identify major emerging trends:

- Smart homes
- Green buildings
- Affordable housing schemes
- Co-working spaces
- Peri-urban expansion
- Digital property technology (PropTech)".

“Theoretical Framework

The theoretical framework for this study provides the conceptual foundation for understanding the rapid growth of real estate development in Nigeria and the factors shaping its expansion, opportunities, and challenges. This research draws from multiple interrelated theories to explain the dynamics of urban growth, housing demand, investment patterns, and policy influences within the Nigerian real estate sector. This theoretical frameworks includes:

- Urbanization Theory
- Growth Pole Theory
- Housing Market Theory
- Sustainable Development Theory
- Political Economy Theory”.

2.1 Identified Research Gap

“Despite the growing body of literature on the rapid expansion of real estate development in Nigeria, significant gaps remain in both theoretical understanding and empirical investigation”. “Existing studies have largely focused on macro-level trends such as urbanization, housing deficits, and economic contributions, but many critical dimensions of the sector remain underexplored, fragmented, or insufficiently integrated”. “Identifying these gaps is essential for justifying the relevance of this dissertation and positioning it as a meaningful contribution to knowledge, policy, and practice”.

“Limited Integrated Analysis of Growth Drivers

Most studies examine individual drivers such as urbanization, population growth, or foreign direct investment in isolation. There is a lack of integrated frameworks that simultaneously analyze how these variables interact to influence real estate growth”.

“Gap Identified:

Absence of multi-variable, system-based analysis

Limited understanding of interdependencies among growth drivers”

“Contribution of This Study:

This research adopts a holistic analytical approach, examining demographic, economic, institutional, and policy factors together within a unified framework".

"Insufficient Empirical Evidence Linking Real Estate to Economic Diversification

While it is widely acknowledged that real estate contributes to GDP, there is limited empirical quantification of its role in reducing dependence on oil and promoting economic diversification".

"Gap Identified:

Weak empirical linkage between real estate growth and diversification outcomes Limited sectoral impact analysis".

"Contribution of This Study:

This dissertation critically evaluates the sector's contribution to economic diversification using secondary data and comparative analysis".

"Persistent Housing Deficit Without Adequate Explanation

Although numerous studies highlight Nigeria's housing deficit, there is inadequate explanation of why the deficit persists despite rapid real estate growth".

"Gap Identified:

Limited analysis of mismatch between supply and affordability Insufficient focus on structural inefficiencies in housing delivery".

"Contribution of This Study:

The study investigates the disconnect between real estate expansion and housing accessibility, emphasizing affordability and income inequality".

"Underdeveloped Research on Mortgage and Housing Finance Systems

The role of housing finance in shaping real estate outcomes is often acknowledged but insufficiently explored in depth".

"Gap Identified:

Limited empirical studies on mortgage penetration Lack of detailed analysis of financial constraints Inadequate evaluation of housing finance reforms". "Contribution of This Study:

This research examines how mortgage accessibility and financial systems act as mediating factors in real estate development".

"Weak Focus on Institutional and Policy Effectiveness

Existing literature frequently mentions policy inconsistency and land administration challenges but lacks systematic evaluation of policy effectiveness".

"Gap Identified:

Limited assessment of implementation gaps Lack of comparative policy analysis Insufficient focus on governance quality".

"Contribution of This Study:

The dissertation critically evaluates policy frameworks, land laws, and institutional performance".

"Limited Attention to Regional and Spatial Disparities"

"Most research is concentrated on major cities such as Lagos and Abuja, with little attention to regional variations across Nigeria".

"Gap Identified:

Urban bias in research

Lack of analysis of secondary cities and rural areas Limited spatial distribution studies".

"Contribution of This Study:

This study acknowledges regional disparities and highlights the need for more balanced development strategies".

Inadequate Exploration of Social Inequality and Inclusivity

The social consequences of real estate growth particularly inequality in housing access are not sufficiently examined.

Gap Identified:

Limited focus on low-income housing access Insufficient analysis of social exclusion

Lack of inclusive housing frameworks

Contribution of This Study:

The research integrates social equity into the analysis, emphasizing affordability and inclusive development.

Limited Research on Sustainability and Environmental Impact

Rapid real estate development raises concerns about environmental sustainability, yet this area remains under-researched.

Gap Identified:

Lack of focus on green building practices Limited environmental impact assessments

Weak integration of sustainability into housing studies

Contribution of This Study:

This dissertation incorporates sustainability considerations into the evaluation of real estate growth.

Scarcity of Longitudinal and Comparative Studies

Most existing studies are cross-sectional and do not capture changes over time.

Gap Identified:

Lack of longitudinal analysis

Limited comparison with other developing economies Insufficient trend-based evaluation

Contribution of This Study:

This research uses a trend-based and comparative perspective to analyze real estate development patterns.

Fragmented Theoretical Application

There is no dominant theoretical framework consistently applied across studies of real estate development in Nigeria.

Gap Identified:

Fragmented use of theories (urbanization, housing market, political economy) Lack of integrated conceptual models

Contribution of This Study:

The study develops a multi-theoretical framework, combining urbanization theory, housing market theory, and political economy perspectives.

2. Research Methodology

2.1 Research Design

The study adopts a **qualitative** and **descriptive** research design.

Qualitative research: is appropriate because the study primarily focuses on understanding trends, patterns, institutional structures, policy frameworks, and socio-economic implications of real estate development rather than solely relying on numerical measurement**.**

2.2 Data Collection Methods

My data is collected on secondary based source due to some financial restriction to travel back to Nigeria. This study adopts a qualitative research approach based on secondary data sources. Data were collected from academic journals, government reports, and publications from international organizations such as the World Bank and African Development Bank. The study analyzes trends in Nigeria's real estate sector and evaluates its economic and infrastructural impact.

The two main approaches used to source out data and area of concentrations are:

A. Qualitative Data:

This includes non-numerical information used to interpret policies, institutional frameworks, and sectoral trends, such as:

- Government housing policies
- Land administration laws

- Urban development regulations
- Academic literature
- Policy analyses
- Industry reports
- Institutional publications

The data has been gathered from different official sources including;

- National Bureau of Statistics (NBS)
- Federal Ministry of Housing and Urban Development
- Central Bank of Nigeria (CBN)
- Federal Mortgage Bank of Nigeria (FMBN)
- National Housing Policy documents
- Land Use regulatory publications

Academic Sources

- Journal articles
- University theses
- Scholarly books
- Conference papers
- Housing policy studies

International Institutional Sources

- World Bank
- United Nations Habitat
- African Development Bank
- International Monetary Fund

"The data collection process for this dissertation was designed to ensure comprehensive, reliable, and policy-relevant analysis of the rapid growth of real estate development in Nigeria. Through extensive use of secondary data from government publications, academic literature, international institutions, and industry reports, the study gathered sufficient evidence to evaluate sectoral growth patterns, economic contributions, housing challenges, policy frameworks, and sustainability concerns".

"This rigorous data collection approach strengthened the overall validity of the research and provided a robust foundation for understanding the opportunities and challenges shaping Nigeria's real estate sector. Ultimately, the chosen data collection strategy ensured that the dissertation produced academically sound and practically relevant findings".

Sampling Strategy

The sampling process focused on selecting documents from authoritative and high-quality sources, including government agencies, international organizations, peer-reviewed journals, and industry reports. The goal was not statistical representation but theoretical completeness and analytical depth, ensuring that the selected materials collectively capture the complexity of Nigeria's real estate sector.

Real estate development in Nigeria encompasses a wide spectrum of activities, including:

- Residential housing estates
- Commercial office developments
- Retail shopping malls
- Industrial parks and logistics hubs
- Hospitality and tourism infrastructure
- Mixed-use urban projects

Large-scale projects such as Eko Atlantic City, Lekki Free Trade Zone developments, and Abuja satellite town expansions exemplify the modernization of Nigeria's property market.

"Despite these positive developments, the rapid expansion of real estate has not fully addressed Nigeria's persistent housing crisis. The country faces one of the world's largest housing deficits, estimated between 22 million and 28 million units. Affordable housing remains inaccessible to

much of the population due to high land costs, weak mortgage penetration, inflation, and limited public sector intervention".

Research Protocol: Database Search Summary

Database	Initial Records	After Screening	Final Inclusion
Google Scholar	~200	~75	~22 peer-reviewed papers
ResearchGate	~100	~45	~12 Nigeria-focused studies
ScienceDirect / Scopus	~90	~38	~13 high-impact journals
Emerald Insight	~50	~22	~8 management and policy papers
PMC / Other Sources	~40	~20	~10 major reports
	~30	~18	~8 official datasets
TOTAL	~510	~178	~73 high-quality sources

Source: Author's Research compilation

3. Findings and discussion

3.1 Presentation of Key Findings

The major findings of the dissertation on the Rapid Growth of Real Estate Development in Nigeria based on the analysis of secondary data, thematic evaluations, descriptive analysis, and policy reviews. The findings reveal the major drivers of sectoral growth, economic contributions, structural barriers, policy gaps, sustainability issues, and social implications of Nigeria's rapidly evolving real estate market.

The results are organized according to the core objectives of the study and reflect how demographic, economic, institutional, and policy variables interact to shape real estate development in Nigeria.

Finding 1: Rapid Urbanization and Population Growth Are Major Drivers of Real Estate Expansion

One of the most significant findings of this study is that Nigeria's rapid population growth and urbanization are the primary structural forces driving real estate development.

Findings:

i. Nigeria's growing population has significantly increased demand for housing, infrastructure, and commercial property.

ii. Rural-to-urban migration has intensified development pressures in major cities.

iii. Urban centers such as Lagos, Abuja, and Port Harcourt have become major real estate growth hubs.

iv. Satellite towns and peri-urban developments are expanding rapidly.

v. Population growth consistently outpaces formal housing supply.

Interpretation:

The study confirms that demographic expansion is both an opportunity for market growth and a major source of housing pressure.

Finding 2: Real Estate Has Become a Significant Contributor to Economic Growth

The research found that real estate now plays a substantial role in Nigeria's economic diversification.

Findings:

The sector contributes significantly to GDP growth. Real estate stimulates construction, finance, transportation, and industrial sectors. Millions of jobs are generated directly and indirectly through: Construction, Surveying, Engineering, Property management, and Mortgage services. Property development has become a major avenue for capital formation and wealth creation while domestic and diaspora investments increasingly target property markets.

Interpretation:

Real estate has evolved into one of Nigeria's most strategic non-oil sectors.

Finding 3: Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) Has Accelerated Sector Growth Another major finding is the strong influence of foreign investment on real estate expansion.

Findings:

International investors increasingly finance:

- Infrastructure projects
- Luxury housing
- Commercial developments
- Industrial parks
- Countries such as China and the United Arab Emirates have played notable roles.
- Foreign-backed infrastructure improves land value and development potential.
- Public-private partnerships have expanded investment opportunities.

Interpretation:

FDI has strengthened market growth but often emphasizes large-scale commercial or high-income projects over affordable housing.

Findings 4: Housing Deficit Remains Severe Despite Sectoral Growth

A critical paradox identified in the study is that rapid growth has not adequately solved Nigeria's housing shortage.

Findings:

i. Nigeria continues to face a major housing deficit.
ii. Affordable housing remains insufficient for low- and middle-income populations.
iii. Rising property prices and rent levels exceed average income growth.
iv. Informal settlements continue to expand.
v. Luxury and upper-income developments dominate major urban markets.

Interpretation:

Real estate growth has been substantial but uneven, with benefits concentrated among wealthier groups.

Finding 5: Mortgage Access and Housing Finance Remain Weak

The study found that inadequate housing finance systems significantly limit inclusive growth.

Findings:

- Mortgage penetration remains very low.
- High interest rates reduce affordability.
- Strict lending conditions restrict broad access.
- Long-term housing finance options are limited.
- Mortgage systems are underdeveloped compared to housing demand.

Interpretation:

Weak mortgage access is one of the largest barriers to mass homeownership.

Finding 6: Land Administration and Policy Barriers Constrain Development

Institutional inefficiencies emerged as a major obstacle.

Findings:

i. The Land Use Act contributes to: Bureaucratic delays, title registration challenges, high transaction costs, and regulatory bottlenecks.

ii. Policy implementation is often inconsistent.

iii. Corruption and administrative inefficiency affect project delivery.

iv. Urban planning systems are frequently weak.

Interpretation:

Policy and governance reforms are essential for unlocking sustainable growth.

Finding7: Regional Development Is Highly Uneven

The study found significant geographic concentration of real estate growth. Findings:

High-growth areas:

- Lagos
- AbujaPort Harcourt

- Lower-growth

regions:

- Rural areas
- Secondary urban centers

Consequences:

- Regional disparities
- Unequal infrastructure access
- Concentrated wealth generation
- Development imbalance

Interpretation:

Growth Pole Theory is strongly reflected in Nigeria's real estate patterns.

Finding 8: Sustainability and Environmental Concerns Are Increasing

The research found that current growth patterns often prioritize speed and profitability over sustainability.

Findings:

- Limited green building adoption
- Environmental degradation risks
- Infrastructure strain
- Flooding vulnerability in urban zones
- Weak long-term planning

Interpretation:

Without sustainability-focused reforms, current growth may generate future urban vulnerabilities.

Finding 9: Social Inequality Is Reinforced by Existing Growth Patterns

The study reveals that real estate expansion often contributes to social stratification. Findings:

i. Gated communities and luxury estates dominate formal growth

ii. Low-income groups remain underserved

iii. Informal settlements continue to grow

iv. Housing affordability gaps widen

v. Wealth concentration increases

Interpretation:

Real estate development, while economically beneficial, may worsen social inequality without inclusive policy intervention.

4. Conclusion and Recommendation

4.1 Conclusion

The rapid growth of real estate development in Nigeria has emerged as one of the most significant indicators of the country's evolving economic transformation, urban modernization, and diversification strategy. Over the past two decades, the Nigerian real estate sector has increasingly shifted from being a peripheral component of the economy to becoming a major contributor to national development through infrastructure expansion, capital formation, employment generation, and wealth creation. This dissertation has demonstrated that real estate development is no longer merely a housing-related activity but a strategic economic sector with substantial influence on broader national growth patterns.

One of the most critical conclusions of this study is that Nigeria's real estate sector has become a major instrument for economic diversification beyond the traditional dependence on oil revenues. As the country continues to seek sustainable alternatives to volatile petroleum markets, real estate has proven to be a viable non-oil sector capable of generating substantial domestic and foreign investments. Through

residential developments, commercial projects, industrial estates, hospitality investments, and large-scale infrastructure initiatives, the sector contributes directly to Gross Domestic Product (GDP) while also stimulating linked industries such as construction, banking, legal services, engineering, transportation, and manufacturing. **Future Research Gap**

Future research on the rapid growth of real estate development in Nigeria should move beyond broad descriptive analyses and focus on deeper empirical investigations that quantify the relationships

between key drivers such as urbanization, population growth, and investment flows. “There is a need for more longitudinal studies that track changes in the real estate sector over time in order to better understand cyclical trends, long-term sustainability, and the evolving impact of policy reforms”.

“Scholars should also explore micro-level analyses that examine household housing behavior, affordability constraints, and access to mortgage finance, particularly among low- and middle-income groups. Such research would provide a clearer understanding of why housing deficits persist despite increased real estate activity. In addition, comparative studies between Nigeria and other emerging economies could offer valuable insights into best practices in housing delivery, land administration, and urban planning”.

“Future research Gap”

“Future research should further investigate the effectiveness of government policies, especially in relation to land use regulation, housing finance systems, and public-private partnerships, with an emphasis on implementation gaps rather than policy design alone. There is also a strong need to examine the role of informal real estate markets, which remain largely undocumented but play a significant role in housing provision across the country”.

“Environmental sustainability presents another important area for future inquiry, particularly the integration of green building practices, climate resilience, and sustainable urban development into real estate expansion. Researchers should assess the environmental costs of rapid urban growth and propose frameworks for balancing development with ecological preservation”.

“Finally, future studies should incorporate interdisciplinary approaches that combine economics, urban planning, sociology, and environmental studies to provide a more holistic understanding of real estate development. By adopting mixed-method research designs and leveraging both primary and secondary data, future research can

generate more robust, context-specific insights that support inclusive, sustainable, and well-regulated growth in Nigeria’s real estate sector”.

4.2 Recommendations

“To ensure that the rapid growth of real estate development in Nigeria translates into sustainable economic progress, inclusive housing access, and long-term national development, this dissertation proposes several strategic recommendations. These recommendations are designed to address the

major structural, institutional, economic, and social challenges identified throughout the study while strengthening the sector's capacity to contribute more effectively to national transformation".

i. **Policy Stability:** Government should ensure consistent and transparent policies.

ii. **Improved Security:** Address insecurity to attract more investment.

iii. **Affordable Housing Schemes:** Introduce subsidies and flexible mortgage systems.

iv. **"Public-Private Partnerships**: Encourage collaboration for infrastructure development".

v. **"Anti-Corruption Measures:** Strengthen institutions to ensure accountability".

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